Major Metropolitan Areas on an Administrative / Official-Region Basis

Years and definitions differ by row, so ranks are indicative only. Yellow rows in the source indicated figures from memory or rough estimates, not verified in that session. Chennai's population estimate was linked to a separate "Chennai test" sheet.

Rank	Metro	Country	Definition used	Area (km²)	Population (millions)	Data year	Status	Source / notes
1	Delhi NCR	India	National Capital Region planning region (NCRPB)	55,083	58.15	2011 census	Sourced	NCRPB Annual Report 2020–21: 581.5 lakh (ncrpb.nic.in). Much older than other rows; 2026 likely far higher.
2	Tokyo	Japan	Greater Tokyo / Tokyo Metropolitan Area	n/a	37.00	c. 2019	Partly sourced	ETV Bharat (Nov 2019) cites ~37M; definition and area not given. JICA report gives 8,014 km² / 32M for a narrower definition.
3	Jabodetabek (Jakarta)	Indonesia	Jabodetabek official metro definition (BPS)	6,392	33.88	2018	Partly sourced	33.88M per BPS via ukmindonesia.id; 2010 census 27.96M over 6,392 km² (Wikipedia/BPS).
4	Chongqing	China	Municipality (administrative)	82,403	31.00	end-2025	Sourced	Jiemian (2026): "exceeding 31 million". Area per Wikipedia 'List of largest cities'. Includes large rural area.
5	Seoul capital area	South Korea	Seoul + Incheon + Gyeonggi	n/a	26.00	c. 2024	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory; not checked this session.
6	Mumbai MMR	India	Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMRDA)	4,355	25.80	2023	Sourced	MMRDA via PTI (Oct): 2.58 crore in 2023. Area 4,355 km² (MMRDA); jurisdiction later reported extended to 6,355 km².
7	Shanghai	China	Municipality (administrative)	n/a	24.80	c. 2024	Partly sourced	Jiemian confirms >20M; exact figure from memory.
8	Dhaka	Bangladesh	Greater Dhaka (definition varies)	n/a	23.00	c. 2024	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory; very definition-dependent.
9	Cairo	Egypt	Greater Cairo Region	n/a	22.00	c. 2024	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory.
10	Beijing	China	Municipality (administrative)	n/a	21.80	c. 2024	Partly sourced	Jiemian confirms >20M; exact figure from memory.
10	Mexico City	Mexico	Zona Metropolitana del Valle de México	n/a	21.80	2020 census	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory.
12	Chengdu	China	Municipality (administrative)	n/a	21.40	c. 2024	Partly sourced	Jiemian confirms >20M; exact figure from memory.
13	São Paulo	Brazil	Região Metropolitana de São Paulo	n/a	21.00	2022 census	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory.
14	Karachi	Pakistan	Karachi Division (7 districts)	3,527	20.38	2023 census	Sourced	Pakistan Bureau of Statistics 2023 census: 20,382,881 (pbs.gov.pk).
15	New York	USA	New York–Newark–Jersey City MSA	n/a	19.50	c. 2023	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory (US Census MSA).
16	Guangzhou	China	Municipality (administrative)	n/a	19.10	end-2025	Sourced	Jiemian (2026): permanent population 19.1M.
17	Osaka–Kobe–Kyoto	Japan	Keihanshin metropolitan area	n/a	19.00	c. 2020	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory.
18	Shenzhen	China	Municipality (administrative)	n/a	18.25	end-2025	Sourced	Shenzhen statistical bulletin via 36Kr/Jiemian: 18.2485M permanent residents.
19	Kinshasa	DR Congo	Kinshasa province	n/a	17.00	c. 2024	Memory – verify	Rough estimate, from memory; no recent census.
20	Lagos	Nigeria	Lagos State / metro (disputed)	n/a	16.00	c. 2024	Memory – verify	Rough estimate, from memory; figures vary widely.
21	Istanbul	Turkey	Metropolitan municipality = province	n/a	15.75	2025	Sourced	TurkStat via Anadolu/Qazinform (Feb 2026): 15.75M.
22	Chennai	India	Chennai Metropolitan Area, expanded Oct 2022	5,904	15.50	2026 (est.)	Estimate	Linked to 'Chennai test'!B3. Estimate from this conversation (2023 density × area ~14.5M, grown to 2026); no official 2026 count. CMDA projections for the 5,904 km² area were under discussion (June 2026).
23	Buenos Aires	Argentina	Área Metropolitana de Buenos Aires	n/a	15.00	c. 2022	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory.
24	Kolkata	India	Kolkata Metropolitan Area (KMDA)	n/a	14.10	2011 census	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory; old census figure.
25	Bengaluru	India	Bengaluru metro (definition varies)	n/a	14.00	c. 2026	Memory – verify	Rough estimate, from memory; BMRDA region is larger.
26	Tianjin	China	Municipality (administrative)	n/a	13.90	2020 census	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory.
27	Metro Manila	Philippines	National Capital Region	n/a	13.50	2020 census	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory.

Rank	Metro	Country	Definition used	Area (km²)	Population (millions)	Data year	Status	Source / notes
28	Lahore	Pakistan	Lahore Division	n/a	13.00	2023 census	Memory – verify	Approximate, from memory.

Note: This is a layout reconstruction of the supplied table. Population values, rank order, definitions, and source notes have been retained from the PDF text; they have not been independently fact-checked.